

SAM DECOTEAU

UX ENGINEER & PRODUCT DESIGNER

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Designing intuitive, accessible products that simplify complex systems.

With a background in development and creative design, I specialize in building enterprise web applications that balance technical complexity with user needs. Experienced in React, TypeScript, Design Systems, and AI-assisted workflows. Moving seamlessly between wireframes, code, and stakeholder communications, with a focus on accessibility and usability.

SKILLS

UX + Product: Interactive Design • Wireframing • Prototyping • Information Architecture • UX Research • Systems Design • Accessibility/Usability Testing (WCAG 2.1)

Development: React.js • TypeScript • JavaScript • HTML5/CSS3 • Node.js • Firebase • RESTful APIs • MongoDB • Express • Python • Wordpress • PHP

Design: Component pattern libraries • design token creation and mapping • theming systems • design-to-code workflows • Figma • Sketch • Miro • Monday.com • Adobe Creative Suite (Lightroom, Photoshop, Illustrator, After Effects, Premier, InDesign)

AI & Emerging Tech: Local LLM deployment (Ollama, Docker, Open WebUI), prompt engineering (Claude, ChatGPT, DeepSeek, Gemini)

WORK EXPERIENCE

Product Designer + Front-End Developer

AESARA | Chapel Hill, NC (Remote) | June 2020 - Oct 2024

- Led UX strategy for enterprise HEOR platform, creating wireframes and interactive prototypes in Figma before implementing production UI in React.js with TypeScript.
- Built and maintained component architecture using modern React patterns (custom hooks, compound components) and established a reusable component library with design consistency across the platform.
- Developed accessible, WCAG 2.1-compliant UI components with cross-browser compatibility and responsive design patterns.
- Collaborated with backend engineers to integrate RESTful APIs and optimize application performance for large clinical datasets in an Agile/Scrum environment.

Full Stack Product Engineer

Resilient Coders | Cambridge, MA | Jan 2020 - June 2020

- Developed 13 user-facing web applications using JavaScript, Node.js, Express, and MongoDB with emphasis on responsive design, accessibility, and modern development practices

Campus Recruiter

Wayfair | Boston, MA | Feb 2018 - Dec 2019

- Partnered with engineering and product leadership to identify and recruit top-tier technical talent; co-led employee engagement initiatives
- Co-led WayBlack Employee Resource Group, strengthening diverse recruitment efforts and increasing collaboration through engaging internal communications and events

PORTFOLIO PROJECTS

DiscoverEats - Interactive Data Visualization p=Platform

Tech Stack: React • Three.js • JavaScript • Figma • Netlify

Designed and developed an immersive web-based experience visualizing global food migration and cultural history. Created wireframes and information architecture, then implemented interactive mapping interface with React and JavaScript, integrating external APIs for data processing.

Internal Chatbot (AESARA Take-Home Assessment)

Tech Stack: FeatherJS • Socket.io • Firebase • JavaScript • Adobe XD

Designed conversational user flows and prototyped real-time interface using FeatherJS, Socket.io, and Firebase. Implemented bidirectional communication, state management, and user authentication for team collaboration workflows.

EDUCATION

B.A. Food Studies, Design, and Media

Johnson & Wales University | Providence, RI | June 2026

Relevant Coursework: Human-Computer Interaction • User Research Methods • Information Architecture

Additional Training: Photography Certificate, Boston University Center for Digital Imaging Arts (2010)